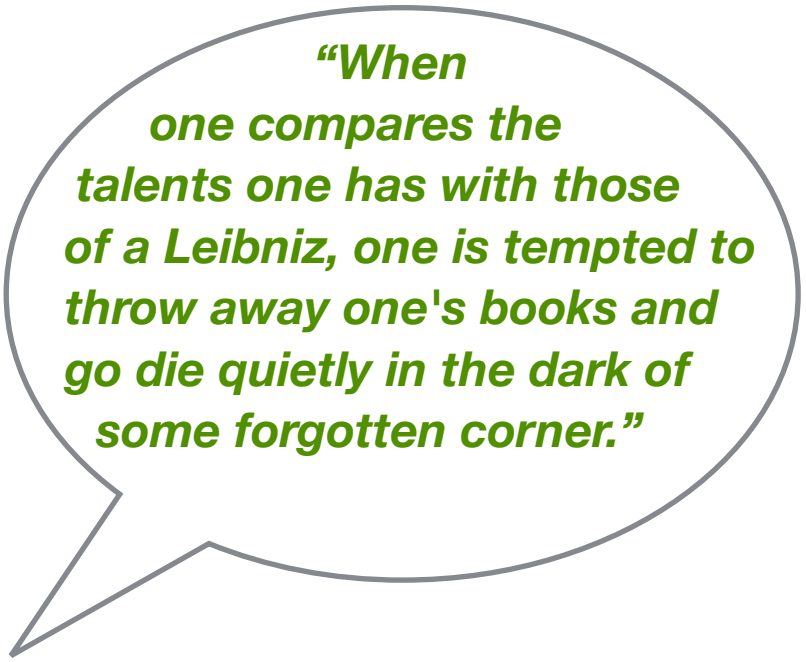


The form of the cosmological argument we'll be discussing today is due to Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz. Leibniz was a German philosopher, mathematician, theologian, and scientist, whose achievements included the invention of calculus.



His intellect and achievements were such
that they led Diderot, a later French
philosopher, to remark that



A large, light gray speech bubble with a dark gray outline. It has a long tail pointing towards the bottom left corner. Inside the bubble, a quote is written in a bold, green, italicized serif font.

***“When
one compares the
talents one has with those
of a Leibniz, one is tempted to
throw away one's books and
go die quietly in the dark of
some forgotten corner.”***



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR

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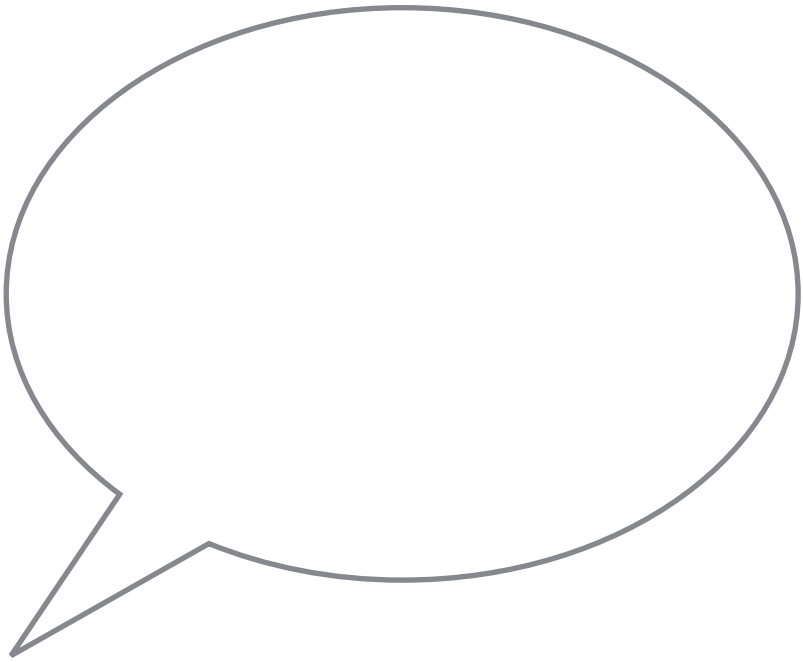
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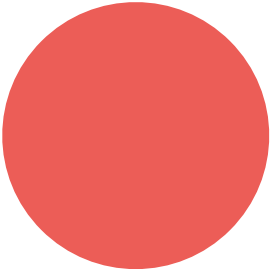
throw away one's books and

... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

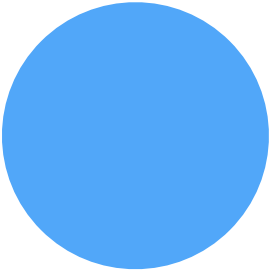
What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.







objections
to the
PSR





Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

be Good.

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR





Leibniz's
argument

